1. Introduction to Creativity and Innovation, and Basic Theories

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Objectives

The main objective will be identifying the basic theories of creativity and innovation, understanding and generating new creative and innovation-oriented operational processes.

At the end of this unit, you will be able to:

- describe the basic theories of creativity and innovation,
- identify the nature of creative and innovative processes, and
- generate new operational processes.

Training outlines

- Introduction to creativity and innovation
- Basic theories of creativity and innovation

Brainstorming questions

1. What is creativity?
2. What is innovation?
3. Comapre creativity vs. innovation

Introduction to creativity and innovation

Creativity: It is the ability to generate new and original ideas, concepts, or solutions.

It involves **thinking outside the box** and using imagination to create something that did not previously exist.

Characteristics of creativity:

- ✓ **Originality:** Producing unique ideas or approaches.
- ✓ **Imagination**: Using mental visualization and abstract thinking.
- ✓ **Divergent thinking**: The ability to think in multiple directions and explore various possibilities.

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Innovation: It is the process of implementing creative ideas in a way that adds value or improves existing products, services, or processes.

It often involves bringing new concepts to market or improving upon existing ones.

Characteristics of innovation:

- ✓ **Practical application**: Turning creative ideas into actionable solutions or products.
- ✓ **Value creation**: Focusing on enhancing efficiency, effectiveness, or services.
- ✓ **Change**: Often leads to significant changes in technology, business models, or societal practices.
- ✓ **Incremental or disruptive:** Can involve small improvements (incremental) or groundbreaking changes (disruptive).

No	Differences	Creativity	Innovation
1	Definition	Thinking of new things	Doing new things
2	Process	Imaginative	Productive & Strategic
3	Focus	Focus on new ideas	Focus on implementation
4	Measurement	Cannot measured	Can be measured
5	Risk	No financial risk	Involve time,& resources lose

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- **Behavioral** competencies encompass a range of **interpersonal skills**, **emotional intelligence,** and **personal qualities** that enable individuals to interact effectively with others, navigate challenges, and achieve organizational goals.
- **Creativity** is the **starting point for innovation**, and **innovation** is the **implementation of creative** inspiration.
- Creativity and innovation are important driving forces for **personal development**, **economic growth**, and **societal advancement**.
- To enhance creativity and innovation, there are **basic theories**.

1.1. Shrinking Earth Theory

- The **shrinking earth theory** states that the **world is shrinking partly** due to the **development of internet of things** which allows telecommunications to connect people from many **diverse locations** and global collaboration for creativity and innovation.
- There are various **ways to leverage the idea** of a shrinking earth theory for **fostering** creativity and innovation.

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Some ways to leverage the shrinking earth theory for creativity and innovation are:

- ✓ Forcing individuals to **think outside the box**.
- ✓ Encouraging brainstorming sessions, and creating cross-disciplinary teams to generate diverse ideas.
- ✓ Encouraging a culture of resilience where teams are prompted to pivot and adapt their ideas in response to feedback or changing circumstances.
- ✓ **O**rganizing innovation challenges that encourage teams to explore unconventional ideas or technologies, and push the boundaries of traditional thinking.

1.2. Systems Theory

- Systems Theory has been used to **understand the behavior of organizations and actors** therein.
- Systems Theory are to model a system's dynamics, **constraints**, **conditions**, and **relations** in a wide range of fields for achieving optimized results.
- It is about **developing broadly applicable concepts and principles**, as opposed to concepts and principles specific to one domain of knowledge.
- Systems Theory provides a **holistic framework** for **understanding complex interactions** and **relationships** within various environments, and making it a valuable lens through which to explore creativity and innovation.

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Some methods to leverage the Systems Theory for creativity and innovation are:

✓ Encouraging teams to identify elements and map out relationships and influences within their creative and innovative processes.

✓ **I**mplementing mechanisms for continuous feedback.

✓ Encouraging a mindset that embraces change as a catalyst for creativity and innovation.

✓ Promoting diversity in teams and encouraging inclusive practices.

✓ **T**raining team members in systemic thinking techniques to analyze challenges and identify leverage points for creativity and innovation.

1.3. Honing Theory

- The Honing Theory posits that **creativity arises from the continuous refinement** and **redefinition** of a **person's worldview** by the **subconscious mind.**
- The Honing Theory suggests that creativity fuels the process by which culture evolves through communal exchange amongst minds.
- The Honing Theory can be understood as **a conceptual framework** that emphasizes the importance of **refining and perfecting ideas over time**.
- The Honing Theory can be applied to enhance creativity and innovation in different ways.

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Some key ways to apply Honing Theory for enhancing creativity and innovation are:

- Encouraging teams to adopt a cyclical approach to creative and innovative projects.

✓ Implementing structured feedback mechanisms.

✓ **I**mplementing a prototyping phase in the creative process, and encouraging teams to create low-fidelity prototypes.

✓ Incorporating regular reflection sessions where individuals or teams assess **what worked**, **what didn't, and how they can improve** their creative processes.

✓ Creating a safe space for experimentation where failure is viewed as a learning opportunity rather than a setback.

1.4. Everyday Imaginative Thought Theory

- Everyday Imaginative Thought Theory suggests that imaginative thought occurs in daily life to foster creativity and innovation across various domains.
- Everyday creativity encourages new knowledge and self-insight to allow daily problem solving and plot the future.
- The idea of everyday creativity as a fundamental human capability which enables inventiveness and adaptation.

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Some of the **key implications** of this theory for enhancing creativity are:

- ✓ Encouraging individuals to recognize and value their imaginative thoughts.
- ✓ Creating environments that stimulate imaginative thought.
- ✓ Promoting a culture of continuous improvement.
- ✓ Fostering diversity within teams and encourages cross-disciplinary collaboration to leverage different perspectives in creative process.
- ✓ Introducing mindfulness practices to help individuals clear their minds and become more receptive to imaginative ideas.

1.5. Evolution Theory

- Evolution Theory, primarily associated with **Charles Darwin**, is a scientific explanation for the diversity of life on Earth.
- Evolution Theory **suggests** that creativity and innovation **evolve over time through a series of adaptations**, **variations**, and **selections**, much like species adapt to their environments.
- It can provide a **compelling framework** for understanding creativity and innovation.
- Creative individuals are willing to **iterate on their ideas** and pivot, which can lead to more resilient and successful innovations.

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The **key ways to implement** this theory are:

- ✓ Encouraging brainstorming sessions where team members can propose a wide range of ideas without criticism, fostering a culture of diversity in thought.
- ✓ Implementing processes for evaluating and **selecting the best ideas**.
- ✓ Promoting knowledge sharing and collaboration across teams to ensure that insights and innovations are documented and accessible for future.
- ✓ Creating an environment that supports creativity, providing resources, and leveraging technology to enhance creative processes.

1.6. Investment Theory

- Investment Theory examines how individuals and institutions **make decisions** about allocating resources, aiming to optimize returns while managing risk.
- **Various strategies** exist within investment theory: *value investing*, *growth investing*, *income investing*, and *index investing*.
- Investment Theory provides **a framework for understanding** how investors **make decisions and manage their portfolios.**
- Investment Theory suggests that **creativity can be viewed through the lens of investment.**

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Some key **techniques to implement** this theory are:

Assessing how organizations allocate resources.

- ✓ Encouraging a culture that embraces calculated risks, allowing teams to experiment new ideas without fear of failure, and recognizing that not all investments will pay off.
- ✓ Balancing project portfolios to include both quick wins and long-term strategic initiatives.
- ✓ Fostering a diverse team environment where different backgrounds and viewpoints contribute to the creative process.
- ✓ creating key performance indicators (KPIs), and establishing policies and practices.

1.7. Social Personality Theory

- Social Personality Theory is an area of **psychology** that examines how individual personality traits influence social behavior and interactions..
- Personality traits are enduring characteristics that influence how individuals think, feel, and behave.
- Social behavior refers to how individuals interact with others.
- Social Personality Theory provides valuable insights into the interplay between individual personality traits and social behavior.

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Some key ways to implement this theory are the followings:

- ✓ Understanding personality profiles of team members.
- ✓ Facilitating teamwork and collaborative environments where individuals can share ideas freely and engage in constructive dialogue.
- ✓ Creating mentorship programs for creative projects.
- ✓ Promoting diversity within teams and all voices are heard.
- ✓ Developing effective leadership strategies that promote positive group dynamics and facilitate open communication among team members.

Thank You!